



IMPACT REPORT

Solar Lantern Distribution Programme

"From Darkness to Light"

Sahara Jan Kalyan Samiti

In partnership with Jiv Daya Foundation, USA

Forest-Fringe Tribal Villages, Sagar District, Madhya Pradesh, India

50+ Families Reached	3 Villages Covered	0 Grid Electricity	100% Solar Powered
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Executive Summary

Sahara Jan Kalyan Samiti, working together with Jiv Daya Foundation (USA), has completed a solar lantern distribution drive reaching more than 50 households across three forest-fringe tribal villages in Sagar district, Madhya Pradesh, India. Every family received a solar LED lantern together with a solar charging panel — a simple, durable, zero-running-cost source of light for homes that have never been connected to the electricity grid.

This report sets out the everyday reality these families face after sunset, the specific risks a lack of light creates in a forested, monsoon-affected terrain, and the concrete difference this programme is already making in their lives. It closes with an invitation to donors — in India and abroad — to help extend this light to the many villages still waiting for it.

The Problem: Life After Dark, Without Light

The villages covered by this programme sit at the edge of dense forest land in Sagar district. None of the homes here — mud-walled huts, tin-sheet shelters, or brick-and-tarp structures — are connected to the power grid. For every family, night means total darkness.

During the monsoon season, the difficulty compounds sharply. The unpaved paths connecting homes turn into deep, slippery mud; streams swell; footing becomes treacherous even in daylight. After sunset, with no lighting of any kind, these same paths become genuinely dangerous to walk.

What this means in practice, every single night:

- **Fetching water or firewood** — women often need to step outside after dark, walking narrow, waterlogged, unlit paths to reach a source some distance from home.
- **Sanitation** — many households do not have an in-home toilet, so a nightly walk outdoors — often through mud, undergrowth, or near livestock — is unavoidable.
- **Childcare and health emergencies** — a sick child or elder at night means navigating dark, uneven ground to reach help, with no lantern or torch to see the way.
- **Snakes and wildlife** — living at the forest edge brings real risk from snakes and other wildlife after dark — risk that light substantially reduces.
- **Children's education** — with no lighting, study time for schoolchildren effectively ends at sunset, regardless of homework or exams the next day.

Women and young children bear the greatest share of this daily risk, since household duties after dark — water, sanitation, cooking, caring for the sick — fall disproportionately to them.

The Response: One Lantern, One Household, Real Change

The solar lantern distributed through this programme is deliberately simple: a rechargeable LED lantern paired with a small solar panel. Placed in daylight, the panel charges the lantern at no cost; after dark, the household has several hours of clean, reliable light — inside the home and, just as importantly, on the path outside it.



A family at the edge of the forest received a solar lantern and charging panel. With no electricity nearby, this is now their only reliable source of light after sunset.

Direct Benefits Recorded on the Ground

- **Safer movement at night** — families report being able to walk the mud paths around their homes with far greater confidence and far less risk of falling or injury.
- **Protection for women and children** — the specific after-dark tasks that fall to women and children — water, sanitation, checking on livestock — are now done with light in hand.
- **Continued schooling** — children can study after sunset for the first time, closing a gap that previously ended their school day at dusk.
- **Faster response in emergencies** — a sick family member or a snake near the house can now be seen and dealt with immediately, rather than in darkness.
- **Zero ongoing cost** — because the lantern runs entirely on sunlight, families carry no electricity bill and no recurring cost for kerosene or candles.
- **A cleaner alternative** — the lantern replaces kerosene lamps and candles, removing the smoke, fire risk, and fumes that come with them inside small, poorly ventilated homes.

Programme Reach

Village	Terrain & Housing	Families
Village 1	Forest-edge hamlet; tin-and-thatch homes; unpaved, muddy access paths	~25
Village 2	Rahli block settlement; mud-brick homes; no electricity infrastructure	~15
Village 3	Roadside hamlet; brick and tarp-roof shelters; seasonal flooding	~10

Figures reflect field-team tallies at the time of distribution and will be confirmed in the consolidated beneficiary register.

Stories from the Field



In a Rahli-block settlement that has never had an electricity connection, an elderly resident received a solar lantern and panel — light in a home that has never had it before.



In a low-lying, flood-prone hamlet, a woman managing her household received a solar lantern — one less thing to fear when the monsoon rains set in after dark.



A mother, holding her young child, receiving her family's lantern — a household where nightfall previously meant complete darkness.

“Today, we have received the greatest support of our lives — now we are not afraid to walk the muddy paths at night.”

Why This Matters — In Numbers

- **Terrain** — every village in this programme lies at the edge of dense forest, with unpaved, monsoon-affected paths as the only means of movement between homes.
- **Electricity access** — none of the households reached have a grid electricity connection; the solar lantern is, in most cases, the first source of reliable light the family has ever owned.
- **Season** — distribution took place during the monsoon, the period when the risk from darkness, mud, and flooding is at its highest for these communities.
- **Who benefits most** — women and children, who carry the greatest share of after-dark household responsibilities and the greatest exposure to the risks that come with them.

The Road Ahead — Why We Need Your Support

This programme has reached just over 50 families across three villages — a meaningful start, but a small fraction of the tribal households across Sagar district's forest belt still living without electricity or any form of after-dark lighting. Thousands more families face the same mud-choked paths, the same darkness, and the same nightly risks documented in this report.

Every additional solar lantern funded represents one household where a woman no longer has to walk an unlit, muddy path alone at night; one child who can finish homework after sunset; one family protected from the fire risk of a kerosene lamp; and one less household paying, out of very little income, for fuel it does not need to burn.

Sahara Jan Kalyan Samiti and Jiv Daya Foundation, USA, invite individual donors, corporate partners, and international well-wishers to help fund the next phase of this programme, so that this simple, high-impact solution can reach many more villages in the year ahead.

How your contribution helps

- **Every unit funded** — provides one family with a complete solar lantern and charging panel, at a modest one-time cost with no recurring expense to the family or the programme.
- **Field delivery** — our volunteer teams deliver each lantern door-to-door, often walking the same difficult, muddy terrain described in this report to reach every household directly.
- **Transparency** — each distribution is documented on-site, with photographic records maintained for every household reached, as reflected throughout this report.

“Light One Lamp, Change One Life.”

Acknowledgement

This programme was made possible through the combined efforts of Sahara Jan Kalyan Samiti, Rahli, and Jiv Daya Foundation, USA, together with the field volunteers who carried out household-level distribution across all three villages — often on foot, through monsoon mud, to ensure every family received their lantern directly and safely.

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